

4.2.1 Language diversity and change

Students should study a range of examples of language in use and research data to inform their study of diversity and change:

- texts using different sociolects (to include social and occupational groups, gender and ethnicity)
- texts using different dialects (to include regional, national and international varieties of English)
- texts that use language to represent the different groups above
- texts from different periods, from 1600 to the present day
- written, spoken and electronic texts about a range of subjects, for various audiences and purposes in a variety of genres
- items from collections of language data (eg dictionaries, online resources, language corpora)
- research findings (eg tables, graphs, statistics).

When analysing texts and data, students should explore:

- how language varies because of personal, social, geographical and temporal contexts
- why language varies and changes, developing critical knowledge and understanding of different views and explanations
- attitudes to language variation and change
- the use of language according to audience, purpose, genre and mode
- how language is used to enact relationships.

This exploration will include:

- methods of language analysis
- how identity is constructed

- how audiences are addressed and positioned
- the functions of the texts
- the structure and organisation of the texts
- how representations are produced.